The Human Question

AUTHOR INSTRUCTIONS

PREPARING AND SUBMITTING YOUR MANUSCRIPT

The Human Question

A Journal of Humanistic Inquiry

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PURPOSE

The Human Question welcomes work that connects serious scholarship with the conditions of human life. Across law, science, politics, technology and culture, the journal asks what ideas, institutions and discoveries mean for the person and for humanity. Submissions and editorial correspondence take place by email. Readers and authors pay no journal fees. Research articles undergo independent external peer review before acceptance.

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President and Editor-in-Chief: Albert Tan Sin Hon

1. SCOPE AND ARTICLE TYPES

Type	Normal length and review
Research article	6,000–10,000 words; original argument or research; two independent external reviews.
Review essay / critical essay	3,000–6,000 words; sustained scholarly analysis; two independent external reviews.
Book review / editorial / commentary	1,000–2,500 words; editorial assessment; labelled by type. External review, if used, is disclosed on the article.

Word limits include footnotes and exclude the abstract and bibliography. Explain any justified departure in the covering email. Interdisciplinary submissions should make their methods and contribution intelligible to readers outside the author's field. Submissions are considered on a rolling basis; acceptance is never guaranteed. The first issue is in preparation, and no fixed publication frequency is promised at this stage.

2. SUBMIT THREE ITEMS BY EMAIL

An anonymised manuscript. Send an editable Word document; include a PDF where complex layout or scripts need comparison. Remove names, affiliations, acknowledgements and identifying document properties from the review copy. Refer to your own published work in the third person without concealing sources needed to assess the argument.

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Send to editor@thehumanquestionjournal.com. Suggested subject: "Submission | [article type] | [short title]". Do not send passwords, identity documents or raw identifiable research-participant data.

3. MANUSCRIPT PREPARATION

Initial submissions may use any clear and consistent scholarly format. Provide a title, a 150–250-word abstract without abbreviations, citations or footnotes, four to six keywords, informative headings and complete references. Use British English. Number pages. Figures and tables need captions, sources, necessary permissions and descriptive alternative text. Identify the relevant legal or evidential cut-off date where it affects the analysis.

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The editor checks scope, scholarly contribution, completeness, integrity and readiness for review. A desk rejection includes a brief reason. Suitable research and review essays receive double-anonymous review by two independent specialists. Author and reviewer identities are withheld from each other where practicable; public preprints or distinctive research may make identification possible. The handling editor knows the identities and manages conflicts.

The journal aims to acknowledge a submission within seven days, provide an initial assessment within four weeks and seek external reports within six to eight weeks of reviewer acceptance. These are service targets, not guarantees. The editor will explain material delays. Decisions may request minor or major revision, invite a fresh submission, accept or reject. Reviewer recommendations inform an independent editorial decision.

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5. REVISION, ACCEPTANCE AND PUBLICATION

Return a clean revised manuscript, a version showing changes and a response addressing every material reviewer point with page or paragraph locations. Explain disagreements with evidence and courtesy. If more time is needed, contact the editor. An acceptance decision is confirmed in writing only after the required scholarly and integrity checks.

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